Should you need to remove a variable so that it is no longer available in your program, use the built-in `unset()` function:

```
$txt = "Hello world";
unset($txt);
echo $txt;
```

```
Output:
Warning: Undefined variable $txt
```

Legal Variable Names

PHP only allows specific characters to be combined with the $ character to form variables. A legal variable name (the characters immediately after the $) starts with an underscore or ASCII letter, followed by any number of underscores, numbers, or ASCII letters. By "ASCII letter," I mean byte values `0x41` (A) to `0xff` (ÿ) – be aware that not all of these are printable characters (e.g., `0x7f` is a control character, and `0x80` does not have a symbol). And yes, you really can have any number of (legal) characters in a variable name; you'll commonly see these in generated code (e.g., the excellent Twig templating library).

The variable names you choose should be limited by good sense and the possible threat of violence from your team members. In addition to these rules, any good PHP project will be following some form of coding standard (e.g., PSR-12 – see https://www.php-fig.org/psr/psr-12/), which may further restrict your choices. The PSR standards (PSR-1 and PSR-12 to be precise) don't impose any particular limits on variable names, but the general convention is to use `$camelCase`.

Here are some examples of legal variables in PHP:

- `$foo`
- `$_4`
- `$ÿ`
- `$__internal_0abebc74dd811fd7b4cfa4c6a2fdf870d7723c04e8daf6926b04914d6644935f;`